

Metropolitan Planning Commission, Dec. 4th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JsH7byZ9vKA
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Municipal Meeting Report: Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission regular meeting to order **00:00:23**, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance **00:00:28**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Borchers, Mr. Brand, Mr. Carol, Mr. Hensley, Mr. Ivy, Mr. Lache, Miss Cyp, Mr. Smith (8 voting members present, establishing a quorum).
 - **Absent:** Mr. Curley, Mr. Dishman (noted during roll call), Mr. Landis, Mr. Leech.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as the Board President/Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:28](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The board reviewed and approved the November meeting minutes by roll call vote (8 yeses) [00:02:37](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:04:55](#) MPC05-25A: Text Amendment to City Subdivision Regulations (Urban Forestry)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Plan Commission Staff / Muncie Urban Forestry Committee.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to amend the city subdivision ordinance to mirror county requirements regarding tree plantings (adding section 2831 regarding natural features). Staff noted that a focus group (including urban forestry, sanitation, landscaping, and extension representatives) met to discuss the language. Discussions covered bond execution under executive mayoral authority, building commissioner discretion on Certificates of Occupancy (CFOs), and the decision to exclude planting trees directly in the public right-of-way due to potential damage to streets and sidewalks.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - [00:09:34](#) **Malcolm Karens** (Chair, Muncie Urban Forestry Committee) spoke in support, noting trees function as vital urban infrastructure (air filtering, carbon sequestration, urban heat island mitigation), but requested that trees be required in the right-of-way matching the county ordinance.
 - [00:12:59](#) **Dan Ridenower** (Mayor of Muncie) spoke in support, advocating for the ordinance as currently written rather than mandating right-of-way placement due to sidewalk and street damage risks.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with a **Favorable Recommendation** to the City Council by roll call vote (8 yeses, 0 nos) [00:15:57](#). Scheduled for introduction at City Hall on January 5th at 6:45 p.m.
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[00:16:47](#) MPC22-25S: Primary Approval for Mason Ridge Subdivision

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Austin Lewis (Brandon Engineering) representing D.R. Horton and developer Oakmont; Rob Lukemire (D.R. Horton).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Public hearing for primary approval of Mason Ridge subdivision, consisting of 126 lots across a 37-acre parcel (zoned R1) located on the northwest corner of West Jackson Street and North Morrison Avenue. Features include 10.5 acres of green space/common areas, 3 retention ponds, internal sidewalks, and two access points (Morrison Road and Jackson Street). Homes will range from 1,500 to 2,600 sq. ft., priced

from the low \$300ks to \$325k. Developer stated storm water runoff will be reduced by 90% via detention ponds. Board members questioned lot sizing compared to Store Estates, traffic flow, infrastructure impact, and common amenities.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:**

- **00:19:54 Dan Ridenower** (Mayor of Muncie) spoke in support, highlighting regional housing demand, economic impact of commuters moving into the city, and tax revenue distributions (42% to Yorktown schools, 24% to Muncie city services, 19% to county).
- **00:39:34 Wayne Zage** (Resident, Saddlebrook) spoke in opposition, citing concerns over high housing density (approx. 5.95 houses/acre), small lot sizes (6,250 sq. ft. average), constrained building templates, and worsening traffic bottlenecks on Morrison Road.
- **00:44:45 Mark Colette** (Clearwater Condos board member) spoke in opposition, raising concerns regarding narrow lot widths (10 ft between exterior walls), lack of brick facades (all-vinyl appearance), school bus safety near the roundabout, and lot compaction.
- **00:47:50 Dave Wilson** (President, Willow Lake HOA) spoke in opposition, emphasizing the "three Ps" (privacy, property value, peacefulness), potential trespassing/use of Willow Lake amenities by new residents, and requesting an 8-to-10-foot privacy fence along the northern property border.
- **00:50:17 Jill Gasper** (Resident, North Saddlebrook) spoke in opposition, citing adequate existing housing inventory in Muncie, insufficient lot sizes ("cheesebox edition"), and calling for a comprehensive planning pause.
- **00:56:01 Deb Spanis** (Resident, North Seabrook Lane) spoke in opposition, noting parking/density constraints, severe adjacent property flooding issues from runoff, and safety concerns regarding retention ponds.
- **00:58:24 Colobby Gray** (Urban Planner / Environmental Resource Manager) spoke in opposition, arguing that suburban single-family developments are financially unsustainable over the long term due to excessive infrastructure maintenance liabilities relative to generated tax revenue.
- **01:02:02 Linda Gray** (Saddlebrook resident) spoke in opposition, focusing on severe traffic congestion on Morrison Road, speeding, and blocked railroad crossings.
- **01:34:50 Dick Rasel** (North Saddlebrook resident) spoke in opposition, concurring on privacy concerns and requesting fencing along property borders.
- **01:29:28 Lisa Carr** (Willow Lake resident) spoke in opposition, echoing concerns regarding compact lot spacing and requesting privacy buffering.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with conditions (specifically requiring a landscape buffer plan on the north side to address neighbor privacy concerns) by roll call vote (8 yeses, 0 nos) **01:31:25**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: General citizen forum comments were integrated directly into the public hearing testimony for Agenda Item MPC22-25S above.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Legislative Action Report:** Noted recent zoning changes adopted by City Council ([00:16-25Z] at 100 N. Hodson Ave, 9-0 vote) and County Commissioners ([00:17-25Z] and [00:18-25Z] in Daleville and Muncie, 3-0 votes).
 - **Permit & Inspection Statistics:** Director reviewed permit totals (786 issued through November, \$145,328.90 in fees) and inspection figures (1,478 completed by Tom Fouch).
 - **Grants & NPO Conference:** Third SS4A steering committee meeting held; regional transportation safety action plan expected by March. Muncie scheduled to host the 2026 MPO Annual Conference in August, in partnership with Kokomo and Anderson.
 - **Director Recognition:** Director noted receiving the Greater Muncie Chamber of Commerce's 2025 Excellence in Public Service Award.
 - **Upcoming Schedule:** Corrected 2026 meeting schedule provided in member packets.
 - **Electric Fence Update:** Staff reported ongoing information gathering regarding electric fences, with a report forthcoming.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment disposition: **Approved by Voice Vote 01:40:32.**
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